

Bihar Board Class 12 English Book Solutions Chapter 3

A Pinch of Snuff

A. Answer the following questions orally (Answer to these questions may vary from person to person)

Question 1.

Do guests visit your house frequently? How do you respond to them?

Answer:

Yes guests frequently visit our house. We entertain them as best we can.

Question 2.

Do you like all of them equally? How often do you entertain your guests gladly?

Answer:

No, I don't like all of them equally. I don't entertain all of them gladly.

Question 3.

At times you may have to welcome a guest whom you don't like much. How do you do this?

Answer:

I try to neglect such a guest if possible. But it is not always possible.

B. 1.1. Complete the following sentences on the basis of what you have studied

(a)..... was coming to visit the narrator's family.

(b) The narrator was on probation.

(c) Nanukaka was to stay for days.

(d) Nanukaka was coming to Delhi to.....

(e).....informed the under secretary about Nanukaka's visit.

(f) The under secretary had to put a charpoy for himself in back verandah because.....

(g) Nanukaka was related to the narrator as he was.....

Answer:

(a) Nanukaka, (b) an under secretary, (c) two or three, (see a minister, (e) His mother, (f) his mother had installed nanukaka in his bedroom, (g) his mother's brother.

B. 1.2. Answer the following questions briefly

Question 1.

The news that made the mother happy disturbed her son. Why news that made the mother happy disturbed her son. Why were their responses to different?

Answer:

Nanukaka was mother's brother. She loved him and was happy to know that he was coming to stay with them. But for the narrator his stay meant inconvenience. He was expected to be at nanukaka's back and call during his stay.

Question 2.

Do you have a similar experience ? Has your response to the news of the arrival of any guest ever been different from that of other meambers of the family ?

Answer:

Yes, I have had a similar experience. The news of the arrival of my cousin made me happy but my family was disturbed. I and my cousin are best of friends. When she arrives, we spend most of our time together. She comes from a small town and likes to go to movies, restaurants, shopping complexes, museums and the zoo. I spend money don't allow her to spend any. My family does not like my going out with her and spending so much money.

Question 3.

'Had to travel second on a third elase ticket? But it was all arranged quite amicably ?' What 'arrangement' Nanukaka is referring to ? How can such arrangement be amicable?

Answer:

Nanukaka was a very clever man. He could manage to come out of any difficult situation. He must have explained to the ticket collector why he had to travel second class in a third class ticket. Then he might have bribed him too. This arrangement was amicable because both the ticket collector and Nanukaka were gainers, and the kitten travelled free.

B. 2. 1. Write T for True and 'F' for False statements

- (a) It was very easy for the narrator to get sent on a foreign assignment,
- (b) Ratiram was the son of Sohanlal Ratiram.
- (c) Sohanlal Ratiram was the Party boss in Delhi.
- (d) Nanukaka went to Lala Sohanlal because they both were Zamindars.
- (e) Nanukaka visited Lala Sohanlal in the guise of an astrologer.
- (f) Nanukaka's meeting with Sohanlal Ratiram was very successful.

Answer:

(a) False (b) True (c) True (d) False (e) False (f) True.

B. 2.2. Answer the following questions briefly

Question 1.

The under secretary always obeyed Nanukaka, although he was never willing to do so, Why?

Answer:

The under secretary was never willing to serve Nanukaka as his Secretary or his driver. But he had to obey him because his mother insisted on it. He could not displease his mother.

Question 2.

“This tie-and -collar business is no good these days.” What did Nanukaka mean to say?

Answer:

It was a time when India had v/on her independence only a few years ago. People did not like tie-and-collar. They liked native clothes.

Question 3.

How did the under secretary change his appearance to accompany Nanukaka?

Answer:

The under secretary changed into a close-collar Jadhपुरi coat and put on a turban, to accompany Nanukaka.

Question 4.

Who is a zamindar? Do you know any zamindar in you locality? What do the people in your locality think about him?

Answer:

A zamindar is an owner of large lands. There is a zamindar in our locality. People think he is very rich and powerful.

Question 5.

How did Nanukaka impress Sohanlal Ratiram?

Answer:

Sohanlal Ratiram wanted to send his son as a Trade Commissioner to Hajrat Barkat Ali, the ambassador of India is Beirut. But his efforts had failed because Hajrat Barkat Ali refused to have him. Nanukaka pretended that Hajrat Barkat Ali was his close friend. When Sohanlal heard this, he was eager to meet Nanukaka. Nanukaka assured that it was quite easy for him and he would surely help him.

Question 6.

What important information did he collect at Ratiram's place?

Answer:

Nanukaka wanted to meet a minister to get some work done. He learnt that the minister wanted to get his daughter married to a prince of Ninnore. The proposal was being considered but the horoscopes were not exchanged yet.

Question 7.

Who is a prince? Do we have any prince now? If yes, do they enjoy the same privileges which they used to do?

Answer:

A prince was a raja of an Indian princely state. But there are no longer any princely states in India now. The princes do not enjoy the privileges they used to enjoy under the British rule.

B.3. Answer the following questions briefly

Question 1.

Who was the second important person Nanukaka had planned to meet?

Answer:

The second important person Nanukaka had planned to meet was ' the welfare minister.

Question 2.

What preparation did he make to meet him?

Answer:

He firstly managed to get an enormous, outlandish car to drive to the minister's office.

Secondly he got undersecretary dressed in his Jodhpur coat and turban and lastly he dressed and sat on the car in a manner that he looked a hereditary pundit from a princely state.

Question 3.

What new role did Nanukaka give the Under-Secretary to play?

Answer:

This time he made the under secretary play a role of the driver of the car, in which he went to the minister's office. The under secretary was dressed as a liveried chauffeur.

Question 4.

How did he manage to impress, the Sikka Auto dealers?

Answer:

He managed to impress Sikka Auto dealers by the demonstration of his wealth. He made a plan with the Dhobi. According to this plan, when he went to Sikka Auto dealers, the Dhobi came with an old coat of Nanukaka in his hand showed him the cheque saying that he left a cheque of Rs. 1000 in his coat. It was a part of his plan. The manager was impressed with his status, Nanukaka managed to show him.

Question 5.

What did he do at minister's residence?

Answer:

With an idea to produce (present) his image of a big zamindar and highly rich person of high reputation Nanukaka did the following at minister's residence

- Firstly he managed a luxuries car for his visit to minister's residence.
- The writer sat on the chauffeur's (driver) seat in a white Jodhpur coat and the orange turban.
- Nanukaka set on the back in a royal dress, looking like a hereditary pundit (as a scholar) and drove to the minister residence.

- At minister's residence he asked to the minister's secretary the visitor's book as he had not time due to some other urgent appointment and that too he did not like to disturb the minister.
- Nanukaka wrote his name, the writer's (undersecretary) Delhi address as his own and added in his introductory note, "Hereditary Astrologer to the Maharaja of Ninnore". Thus he left a deep impression on them of his personality.
- Without speaking anything more and directing the writer to take him to "Maharaja Sutkatta's palace". And the car immediately left the place. He was warmly saluted by the secretary and orderly while leaving minister's house.

Question 6.

How did he impress the minister?

Answer:

He came in an outlandish car with a uniformed chauffeur. Secondly he dressed himself like a hereditary pundit from princely state. While visiting minister's residence and then after getting into the car he shouted loudly to take him to a maharaja's palace to show he had contacts with many aristocrats. Lastly he wrote his name in the visitors book as the Hereditary Astrologer to the Maharaja of Ninnore. This is what he did to impress the minister.

Question 7.

'Is the under-secretary impressed with Nanukaka at any point? When and Why? Find out the evidence from the story.

Answer:

Yes, finally, he was impressed with Nanukaka after he had used his wit to accomplish his mission. He was impressed with Nanukaka for the way he used his brain and finally had a meeting with the minister. The evidence which proves Nanukaka's dealing with the minister impressed the under secretary deeply for his presence of mind. In the last, he says that if minister comes to know about the reality, he is sure that Nanukaka will deal with the situation without allowing a single fold of his anghocha to fall of place.

Question 1.

Nanukaka tells lots of lies. Why does he do so? Does he succeed in his pursuit?

Answer:

Nanukaka tells lots of lies to have a meeting with the welfare minister. Nanukaka makes many false statements because if he had not done so, he could not have met the minister in two-three days. He would have to wait for months to get an appointment for his meeting with